

WT - Rewrite Follow-Ups Feedback

This feedback is based on Inter-Analyst Agreement (IAA). That is, how much do different people analyzing the same task agree with each other? The observations and feedback below are sorted based on the most recurring issues, i.e. from the lowest agreement scores.

1. Personalization — Step 2

This is the highest-risk dimension across locales, often below 40% agreement.

What annotators need to pay attention to:

- The sample outputs are **not** mapped to the actual user — they only illustrate a writing style pattern. You must focus purely on style signals (sentence length, vocabulary complexity, formality markers) and ignore any factual content differences between the sample and the rewrite.
 - "Well matched" does not mean the rewrite is identical to the sample outputs. It means the rewrite consistently reflects the same stylistic category. A single formal word in an otherwise casual rewrite should not push a rating to "Partially matched."
 - For Asian and European locales especially: what counts as "formal", "casual", or "advanced vocabulary" is culturally loaded. You should anchor your judgment to the **sample outputs** provided for that specific task, not to your own cultural baseline for what those labels mean.
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2. Fix Errors — Step 3 Grammar & Clarity

Agreement on this dimension crashes in Asian locales and is unreliable across European ones too. The guideline here is relatively simple with yes/no questions — but the disagreement suggests annotators are applying it inconsistently.

What annotators need to pay attention to:

- This first question only asks whether errors **present in the original** were **fixed**.
 - For languages where grammar rules are more complex or where "error" is more ambiguous (e.g., Chinese where punctuation or character choice can be debated, or European languages with gendered agreement), you need to make a binary call: was there a clear error in the input, and did the rewrite address it? If there was no clear error, mark "Not applicable"; not "Yes".
 - The "Not applicable" option is likely underused. If the original text has no grammatical errors, the answer is N/A, not Yes. Conflating these two inflates disagreement.
 - Q1 is not asking whether the rewrite introduced new errors (that's Q2) or whether the rewrite is generally well-written (Q3).
 - Q2 evaluates if **new** errors were introduced. If errors present in the original were not fixed, this fails Q1, and not Q2.
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3. Preserve Style — Step 5 Meaning Preservation Q2

This dimension asks whether the second rewrite kept style elements from the first rewrite that weren't targeted by the selected suggestion. Agreement is consistently weak in European locales and for tone-related suggestions.

What annotators need to pay attention to:

- The key word is “unrelated”. You should mentally isolate what the selected suggestion targets (e.g., “Soften tone”) and then check everything else (e.g. vocabulary choices, sentence structure, formality level, length) against the first rewrite. Only changes in those unrelated areas count as failures here.
 - A common mistake is penalizing the second rewrite for changes that are a natural side effect of applying the suggestion. For example, softening tone may slightly alter sentence structure. That's acceptable. Completely changing from formal to casual vocabulary when the suggestion was only about brevity is not.
 - For European locales where tone_balance is also weak: tone and style are being conflated. Tone is about emotional register and confidence level; style is about structural and vocabulary patterns. These are separate questions in the rubric and should be assessed separately.
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4. Apply Suggestion — Step 5 Suggestion Adherence Q1

Consistently problematic across locales, especially when the selected suggestion involves tone or register.

What annotators need to pay attention to:

- The standard is “visibly implemented with noticeable changes that directly relate to the suggestion”. Ask yourself: if I compared the first and second rewrite side by side, would I immediately see the suggestion's effect? If yes, mark Yes.
 - Vague or broad suggestions like “Keep it natural” or “Preserve informal tone” are harder to verify. You should look for at least 2–3 concrete markers in the rewrite (word choices, sentence starters, contractions, punctuation style) that reflect the suggestion, rather than looking for a wholesale transformation.
 - For tone-related suggestions: cultural norms around formality differ significantly in some locales. You should judge against your locale's own conventions, not against English-language norms.
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5. Negative Side Effects — Step 5 Quality Improvement Q2

Unreliable across European and Asian locales.

What annotators need to pay attention to:

- This question should only have “No” when there is a **clear, concrete** problem introduced by applying the suggestion, not when you simply prefer a different phrasing. The bar is: does the text now have a problem it didn't have before?
 - “Lost nuance” should only be flagged if a meaningful distinction from the original (a qualifier, a hedging phrase, an important caveat) was removed as a direct result of applying the suggestion. e.g. “I understand why they made the decision, though I still think it was shortsighted”
Rewrite: I think they made a bad decision
 - Length increases from suggestions like “Add more detail” are expected and not negative side effects. You should only mark length as an issue when it becomes genuinely excessive, not just longer than the first rewrite. Certain rewrites require rewording that might slightly alter the length. This is not automatically penalized just because it went, for example, from 20 to 22 words.
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6. Redundancy — Step 4 Follow-up Suggestions

The guidelines define this clearly (two or more suggestions nearly identical or covering similar information), but agreement is weak especially in European locales.

What annotators need to pay attention to:

- "Similar information" means the suggestions would produce essentially the same second rewrite if selected. Two suggestions can use different words and still be redundant if they point in the same direction (e.g., "Keep it brief" and "Cut unnecessary words" are redundant; "Keep it brief" and "Soften the tone" are not).
 - You should test each pair of suggestions against the first rewrite mentally: would choosing one vs. the other produce a meaningfully different output? If not, they're redundant.
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7. Tone Balance — Step 3, Tone Appropriateness Q2

Notably weak across French, German, Spanish, and Italian. The guideline asks whether "the user's personality shows through while meeting situational requirements"; this is inherently cultural.

What annotators need to pay attention to:

- This question is not asking whether the rewrite sounds natural to you. It's asking whether the rewrite strikes a balance between the user's demonstrated writing style and the demands of the context (e.g., a casual person writing a work email).
 - For European locales: professional communication norms vary widely. French professional writing tends toward formality; German tends toward directness; Spanish can be warmer. You should calibrate "situational appropriateness" against your own locale's norms, not a generic standard.
 - The sample outputs are the primary reference for understanding the user's baseline style. If the rewrite drifts significantly away from that style **without** a clear contextual reason, it fails this question. If the drift is justified by the context (writing to a supervisor, making a formal request), it passes.
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8. Localization

The Writing Tools guidelines have their own Localization rules. Do not use the LE guidelines as a reference point. Stick to what the guidelines require, do not report spelling/grammar issues under Localization.